

60 The future in the past

There are a number of constructions in English that you can use to describe thoughts about the future that someone had at some point in the past.

⚙️ **New language** "Would" and "was going to"

Aa **Vocabulary** Changing plans

🧩 **New skill** Saying what you thought

60.1 KEY LANGUAGE THE FUTURE IN THE PAST USING "WOULD"

Where you would use "will" to talk about a future event from the present, you use "would" to talk about your past view of it.



I think I **will** finish the gardening today. It shouldn't take too long.

I thought I **would** finish today, but there is still a lot left to do.



60.2 CROSS OUT THE INCORRECT WORDS IN EACH SENTENCE

I thought I ~~will~~ / **would** go to France last summer, but I didn't. I **will** / ~~would~~ go next year instead.

- David said that he **will** / **would** try to get me a ticket to the game, but he ~~doesn't~~ / ~~didn't~~ manage to.
- I **would** / **will** buy the movie on DVD. I thought I **will** / **would** see it at the movie theater, but I didn't.
- Last year she thought she **will** / **would** be promoted, but she wasn't. Maybe next year she **would** / **will** be.
- I **bring** / **brought** all the food for the picnic because I knew that Tom ~~won't~~ / ~~wouldn't~~ remember.
- We knew that the concert **will** / **would** be amazing, so we **buy** / **bought** really good tickets.
- My brother promised that he ~~won't~~ / ~~wouldn't~~ show anyone pictures of me when I **was** / **were** little.

